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DESIGN CODE NS 02

Kawaii Halloween Mini Set

Boo the Ghost · Pip the Pumpkin · Bramble the Bat

US crochet terms · Intermediate · 2.0–2.2 in / 5–5.5 cm each

Three pocket-sized Halloween minis: a ruffled bell ghost, a deeply sculpted squat pumpkin and a picot-winged bat. Small, fast and forgiving — but the picots, the worked-in-the-round-then-flat wing, and the needle sculpting on Pip put this above a first project.

MATERIALS

Yarn — DK / light worsted (#3) cotton. Cream about 8 g (Boo) · pastel orange about 10 g (Pip) · lavender about 9 g (Bramble) · sage green about 4 g (stem, tendril and leaf) · pale pink about 2 g (ear linings).

These are working amounts, not measured consumption. The set itself uses well under 5 g of each color; the figures allow for tails, sewing, swatching and a second attempt. One small ball of each color is more than enough.

Hook — 2.5 mm (US C-2). Tight enough that stuffing cannot show.

Safety eyes — 2 pairs of 6 mm: one pair for Boo, one pair for Bramble. Pip is a sculpted pumpkin with an embroidered face and needs none.

Floss — Black for Boo's smile and Pip's face, pink for blush, white for Bramble's fangs.

Stuffing — Polyester fiber fill. Pip takes about 2 g, Bramble about 1 g. **Boo takes none** — he is an open bell that stands on his hem. About 5 g covers the set with margin.

Notions — Tapestry needle, stitch markers, pins, scissors.

Safety. Boo and Bramble use safety eyes, which are a small part and a choking hazard. These minis are decorative pieces, not toys for young children, and they have not been tested to a toy-safety standard such as ASTM F963 or EN 71. If you want to give them to a child, embroider the faces instead of using safety eyes and check every seam first.

GAUGE

DK cotton on a 2.5 mm hook: about **3.5 mm per stitch** and **3.2 mm per round**.

Check it on Pip after Rnd 6 — 36 stitches should measure about 40 mm around a firmly stuffed body. Every measurement in this pattern follows from that gauge.

FINISHED SIZE

	width	height
Boo	27 mm at the body, flaring to about 40 mm at the ruffled hem	48 mm including the hem
Pip	40 mm	42 mm
Bramble	33 mm	51 mm, plus an 11.5 cm wingspan

Note on Boo: his width and height are measured on different parts of him. The 27 mm figure is the body tube; the ruffled hem flares well past it. If you quote one number, quote the hem.

ABBREVIATIONS

MR	magic ring
ch	chain
sl st	slip stitch
sc	single crochet
hdc	half double crochet
dc	double crochet
inc	increase — 2 sc in one stitch
dec	invisible decrease
FLO / BLO	front loops only / back loops only
picot	ch 3, sl st in the 3rd ch from the hook
[n]	the stitch count at the end of that round

WORKING NOTES

Work the bodies in **continuous spiral rounds** — do not join and do not chain 1 between rounds. Move a stitch marker into the first stitch of every round.

Bramble's wings are the exception: they are worked **flat, in turned rows**.

Unless a note says otherwise, work every stitch through both loops.

HOW IT COMES TOGETHER

The four techniques this set depends on, in the order you meet them.

1 · The picot

Chain 3, then slip stitch into the 3rd chain from the hook. That makes one small pointed bump. Picots are used on Bramble's wing edges — they are what make the wings read as bat wings rather than leaves.

Keep your picot tension even. A loose picot loops; an over-tight one curls under and disappears.

2 · Working into one loop only

Boo's ruffled hem is worked into the **front loops** of Rnd 12, which leaves the back loops free as a clean ring to sew the optional base onto. Bramble's hat brim works the same way.

When a round says FLO or BLO, insert your hook under only that loop. The unused loop stays visible as a ridge on the other side — that ridge is the join line, and it is meant to be there.

3 · The ruffle shell

Boo's hem repeats this group: **2 sl st, then (sc, hdc, dc, hdc, sc) all into the next single stitch, then 1 sl st**.

Five stitches into one stitch is what makes the fabric flare. Each repeat takes 4 stitches of the round and returns 8, so the edge doubles in length and ruffles.

Six repeats use all 24 stitches of Rnd 12 and produce 48 stitches — six ruffles.

4 · Needle sculpting

This is what turns Pip from an orange ball into a pumpkin, and it is the reason for the long tail you are told to leave.

You will run that tail through the stuffed body with a tapestry needle, entering and exiting at the top and bottom, then pull and anchor it. Each pass pins a channel into the surface. Six evenly spaced passes make six ribs.

The full method is in Pip's assembly, step by step. The short version: **overstuff first**, because sculpting compresses the filling and a soft pumpkin will not hold a rib.

1 · BOO THE RUFFLED GHOST

Worked top-down in cream. Boo is an **open bell** — he has no closed bottom and he takes **no stuffing**. He stands on the weight of his ruffled hem.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[sc, inc] ×6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] ×6	(24)	
R5	sc in each st around	(24)	
R6	sc in each st around	(24)	
R7	sc in each st around	(24)	
R8	[11 sc, inc] ×2	(26)	eyes go on R8-R9
R9	sc in each st around	(26)	
R10	sc in each st around	(26)	arms attach at R10
R11	sc in each st around	(26)	
R12	[11 sc, dec] ×2	(24)	live edge — hem and base both attach here

Do not fasten off. Continue straight into the hem.

Boo · ruffled hem

Work into the **front loops** of Rnd 12.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R13	FLO: [sl st in next 2, (sc, hdc, dc, hdc, sc) in next st, sl st in next] ×6 (48)		each repeat takes 4 sts — closes all 24

Finish. FO and weave in. You should have 6 ruffles. The hem adds about 10 mm of depth, which is included in Boo's 48 mm height.

Boo · eyes

Insert the 6 mm safety eyes **before** you sew anything, while Boo's open bottom still gives you room to reach the washers. Place them on **Rnd 8-9**, about **5 stitches apart**, centered on the front.

Boo's widest round is 26 stitches, so 5 stitches puts the eyes well inside the front of the face. Fit the washers from inside.

Boo · smile and blush

With black floss, embroider a small curved smile centered below the eyes. With pink floss, add a short horizontal stitch either side for blush.

Boo · arms — make 2

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS
R1	5 sc in MR	(5)
R2	sc in each st around	(5)
R3	sc in each st around	(5)

Finish. FO with a 6 in tail. Do not stuff. Sew to the sides at Rnd 10, angled slightly forward.

Boo · flat base — optional

Boo stands on his hem without this. Make the disc only if you want a closed, weighted bottom that lets him stand on an uneven surface.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[sc, inc] ×6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] ×6	(24)	flat disc, matches the 24 back loops of Rnd 12

Finish. FO with a long tail. Do not close it — it stays flat.

Sew it to the **back loops** of Rnd 12, from inside, leaving the hem free to flare below it. A few stitches of the disc can be lightly padded if you want extra weight.

Boo · bonus mini witch hat

The brim stops at 20 stitches so the hat sits on Boo rather than swamping him.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	4 sc in MR	(4)	
R2	[sc, inc] ×2	(6)	
R3	[2 sc, inc] ×2	(8)	
R4	[3 sc, inc] ×2	(10)	
R5	sc in each st around	(10)	
R6	FLO: inc in each st around	(20)	brim

Finish. Sl st, FO.

The brim attaches on a ring about 22 mm across and its outer edge sits about 26 mm out — just under Boo's 27 mm head, so the hat rests on him instead of swamping him. Sew it on tilted.

2 · PIP THE SCULPTED PUMPKIN

Worked bottom-up in pastel orange. Only two straight rounds — that is what keeps Pip squat rather than tall like a lemon.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[sc, inc] ×6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] ×6	(24)	
R5	[3 sc, inc] ×6	(30)	
R6	[4 sc, inc] ×6	(36)	full width — check gauge here
R7	sc in each st around	(36)	
R8	sc in each st around	(36)	
R9	[4 sc, dec] ×6	(30)	
R10	[3 sc, dec] ×6	(24)	stuff firmly, then overstuff
R11	[2 sc, dec] ×6	(18)	
R12	[sc, dec] ×6	(12)	
R13	dec ×6	(6)	

Finish. Do not cut the yarn short. **FO leaving a 25 in / 65 cm tail** — you need that length for sculpting, and you cannot add it later.

Pip · sculpting the ribs

Overstuff Pip **before** you start. Sculpting compresses the filling, and a soft pumpkin will not hold a rib.

1. Thread the 65 cm tail onto a tapestry needle.
2. Find the center of the top (the R13 opening) and the center of the bottom (the R1 magic ring). These are

- your two anchor points. Every pass goes in one and out the other.
3. Bring the needle down through the top center and out at the bottom center. Pull gently until the surface just begins to dimple — do not strangle it.
 4. Move **6 stitches sideways** along the bottom, bring the needle back up to the top center, and pull again. Anchor with a small stitch so the tension holds.
 5. Repeat, moving 6 stitches each time, until you have made **6 passes** all the way around. Six passes on a 36-stitch body divides it into six even ribs.
 6. When the last rib is set, knot the tail against the surface, run the needle into the body and out the side, then pull the knot inside and trim.

Pull every rib to the **same** tension. One tight rib and five loose ones is the most common way this goes wrong.

Pip · face

With black floss, embroider two small triangles for eyes on the front, roughly level with the middle of the body and about 6 stitches apart, then a short zigzag mouth below them. Keep the face inside one rib panel so the sculpting does not cross it.

Pip · stem cone — sage green

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	sc in each st around	(6)	
R3	[sc, inc] ×3	(9)	
R4	sc in each st around	(9)	
R5	[2 sc, inc] ×3	(12)	flared base

Finish. FO with an 8 in tail. Stuff very lightly. Sew to the top center of Pip, over the R13 opening.

Pip · tendril — sage green

Ch 20. Starting from the 2nd ch from the hook, work **sl st in each ch** to the end. FO, leaving a tail.

The slip stitches make the chain curl into a tight spiral. Wind it once around the base of the stem and sew the end down. If it will not hold a curl, work it a few chains longer and wind it more loosely.

Pip · leaf — sage green, make 1

Worked flat, in turned rows.

ROW	INSTRUCTION
Foundation	ch 7
Row 1	From the 2nd ch from the hook: sc in 5, 3 sc in the last ch; working back along the opposite side of the foundation chain, sc in 4, inc in the last
Row 2	ch 1, turn. sc in 4, inc in each of the next 3, sc in 4
Row 3	ch 1, turn. sl st in each st around. FO

Finish. The slip-stitch row gives the leaf a firm rolled edge. Sew it to the stem base, angled out to one side, opposite the tendril.

3 · BRAMBLE THE MINI BAT

Worked top-down in lavender.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[sc, inc] ×6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] ×6	(24)	
R5	sc in each st around	(24)	
R6	sc in each st around	(24)	
R7	sc in each st around	(24)	eyes go on R7–R8
R8	sc in each st around	(24)	
R9	[3 sc, inc] ×6	(30)	wings attach at R9–R11

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R10	sc in each st around	(30)	
R11	sc in each st around	(30)	
R12	sc in each st around	(30)	
R13	[3 sc, dec] ×6	(24)	stuff firmly
R14	[2 sc, dec] ×6	(18)	
R15	[sc, dec] ×6	(12)	
R16	dec ×6	(6)	

Finish. FO with a 6 in tail. Weave it through the final 6 stitches and pull closed.

Bramble · eyes

Insert the 6 mm safety eyes **after Rnd 8, before you continue to Rnd 9.** Bramble closes completely at Rnd 16, so this is your last chance to fit the washers from inside.

Place them on **Rnd 7-8, 4 stitches apart**, centered on the front. Four stitches is close, and deliberately so — Bramble's head is only 24 stitches around, and wide-set eyes on a head this small wrap around to the sides.

Bramble · ears

The pink piece is sewn on top of the lavender one, so there is no two-layer join to get wrong.

Outer — lavender, make 2

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS
R1	4 sc in MR	(4)
R2	[sc, inc] ×2	(6)
R3	[2 sc, inc] ×2	(8)
R4	[3 sc, inc] ×2	(10)

Inner — pale pink, make 2

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS
R1	4 sc in MR	(4)
R2	[sc, inc] ×2	(6)
R3	[2 sc, inc] ×2	(8)

Finish. FO with an 8 in tail on each. Flatten, do not stuff.

Sew a pink inner onto each lavender outer, then sew the pairs to the top of the head at about Rnd 4-5, angled slightly outward.

Bramble · scalloped picot wings — make 2

Worked **flat**, in turned rows.

Ch 13.

Row 1. From the 2nd ch from the hook: sc in 4, hdc in 4, dc in 4. Ch 1, turn. **[12]**

Row 2. sc in 3, hdc in 4, dc in 5. Ch 1, turn. **[12]**

Row 3. sl st in the first 2, (**sc, hdc, dc, picot, dc, hdc, sc**) in the next st, sl st in the next 3, (**sc, hdc, picot, hdc, sc**) in the next st, sl st in the next 2, (**sc, hdc, picot, hdc, sc**) in the next st, sl st in the last 2.

Finish. FO with a 10 in tail.

The slip-stitch groups are **2 / 3 / 2 / 2** — nine stitches — which with the three scallops, worked into one stitch each, consumes all 12 stitches of Row 2. Nothing is left over, so if you have a stitch remaining you have miscounted a group.

The three scallops are **deliberately different sizes**: the middle one is 7 stitches tall with a dc at its peak, and the two outer ones are 5 stitches with an hdc peak. That is what gives the wing its pointed tip and two smaller lobes beside it. Each scallop carries exactly one picot.

Bramble · assembly

Pin the wings to the back and sides between **Rnd 9 and Rnd 11**, angled out and slightly up, then sew along the straight inner edge.

Each wing is about 42 mm long. With a 33 mm body, that gives a wingspan of roughly 11.5 cm.

With white floss, work two small V-stitches just under the eyes for fangs. With pink floss, add blush.

DISPLAY — HALLOWEEN GARLAND

Cut 6 ft of jute twine, or **chain 450** in sage. A chained cord is much shorter than it looks: 150 chains measures only about 60 cm, so you need roughly 450 for a 6 ft cord. Chain a few extra and measure rather than counting exactly.

Make 3 ghosts, 3 pumpkins and 3 bats. Thread 20 mm felt balls between them, and tie or slip-stitch each piece to the cord 4-5 in apart.

Yarn for a full garland: about 25 g cream, 30 g orange, 27 g lavender and 12 g sage — three of each.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Pumpkin looks tall — You worked more than two straight rounds at Rnd 7-8. Extra plain rounds are what turn a pumpkin into a lemon.

Ribs vanish — Overstuff before sculpting, and pull each rib firmly and to the same tension. A soft pumpkin will not hold a rib, and one over-tight rib will pull the whole body out of round.

Ruffle gaps at the marker — Each hem repeat must take exactly 4 stitches: 2 sl st, the shell into 1 stitch, then 1 sl st. Six repeats use all 24.

Wing row runs short — The Row 3 groups are 2 / 3 / 2 / 2. Count the slip stitches, not the scallops.

Wing scallops look uneven — They are meant to be. The middle scallop is the largest; the two outer ones are smaller. Check you have not swapped their order.

Ghost leans — Rnd 8's two increases must be 13 stitches apart. [11 sc, inc] ×2 places them symmetrically.

Ghost will not stand — Boo takes no stuffing and stands on his hem. If he keeps falling, sew on the optional flat base for weight.

Hat swamps the ghost — Stop the brim at Rnd 6, 20 stitches. A 30-stitch brim flares to about 36 mm against Boo's 27 mm head.

Cannot fit the eye washers — You closed the piece first. Boo's eyes go in through his open bottom; Bramble's must go in after Rnd 8, before the body narrows and closes at Rnd 16.

COLORWAYS

Classic cream, orange and lavender. Also: all-white with silver wings, charcoal with orange, or sage-and-oatmeal for a muted autumn set.

BEFORE YOU ASSEMBLE

Lay every component out and check it against the pattern before you sew anything:

- **Boo** — 1 body with hem, 2 arms, 1 optional base, 1 witch hat
- **Pip** — 1 sculpted body, 1 stem cone, 1 tendril, 1 leaf
- **Bramble** — 1 body, 2 lavender ears, 2 pink ear linings, 2 wings

Pin each piece and look at the toy from the front before committing a single stitch.

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